

You Already Have Plex. Perfect.

I'm not asking you to leave Plex. I'm asking you to connect **Impala Streamer** to the library you've already built and decide for yourself.

Performance

Performance was a design goal from day one. Impala Streamer was built lean for speed and efficiency. In testing, it handled multiple video streams and simultaneous transcoding while staying responsive.

Less overhead. More streaming.

Your Invitation

I'm inviting you into my personal **Family Edition of Impala Streamer** so you can experience it with the media library you already own.

If you like Impala and want to keep using it, I'll give you your own **full-featured, private Impala environment with a lifetime license at no cost.**

No subscription. No upsell.

What I want in return is much more valuable to me right now: **use it. Push it. Tell me what works and what doesn't.** Your feedback helps me improve the interface, find problems, and make Impala better for the next person.

And if you genuinely like it, **tell your friends.**

I'm working toward making Impala Streamer a household name, and that starts with real users having a reason to talk about it.

And One More Thing

You're a Plex user, and your perspective is especially valuable.

If you find a feature you've always wished for—something you can't get from Plex or anywhere else—and it aligns with Impala's vision, **I'll build it as a dedicated microservice and bring it into your personal platform.**

I'm not just looking for people to use Impala.

I'm looking for people to help shape what's next.

PLEX vs. IMPALA STREAMER

COMPARISON	PLEX	IMPALA STREAMER
Cost to Get Started	Requires suitable PC/NAS/server hardware, storage drives, networking equipment, and potentially additional upgrades	Family Impala: Free to try
Existing Local Media	Requires Plex Media Server to manage and serve the library	Local Companion connects directly to the user's existing media library
Server Hardware	User supplies and maintains server hardware	No dedicated Impala server hardware required by the Family user
Storage	User purchases, installs, expands, and maintains storage	No new storage required when using an existing local library

COMPARISON	PLEX	IMPALA STREAMER
Network Hardware	Reliable router/network infrastructure can be important for remote streaming	Standard Internet/browser access for hosted streaming; Local Companion handles local-library connection
Installation	Plex Media Server must be installed and configured; client apps may also be installed	Browser-based access; Local Companion installed only when connecting a local media library
Setup	Configure server, libraries, permissions, remote access, transcoding, clients, etc.	Sign in and stream; connect Local Companion when using local media
Technical Knowledge	Server ownership can require networking, storage, transcoding, permissions, and troubleshooting knowledge	Designed so the viewer does not have to become a server administrator
Server Maintenance	Server owner maintains hardware, OS, Plex server software, storage, networking, and availability	Infrastructure managed by Impala; Local Companion provides lightweight access to existing local media
Library Scanning	Automated and manual library scanning available	Library scanning available within the Impala environment / Local Companion workflow
Remote Streaming Performance	Dependent on the owner's server CPU/GPU, upstream bandwidth, transcoding capability, and network	Designed around centralized streaming infrastructure rather than an individual user's home server capacity
Concurrent Users	Capacity depends heavily on server hardware, media formats, transcoding	Architecture designed for substantially larger concurrent audiences; current Impala target/capability is up to

COMPARISON	PLEX	IMPALA STREAMER
	requirements, and upstream bandwidth	approximately 100 users depending on deployment/resources
Sharing	Plex library owner shares access from their server with other Plex users	Impala users can share access without requiring every viewer to own or operate a media server
Synchronized Playback	Plex introduced Watch Together ; availability/support has changed and the experience is not a central Plex capability	Sync Play is a core Impala capability designed for synchronized viewing
Sync Play Control	Limited by Plex's Watch Together implementation and supported clients	Impala provides synchronized playback control as part of the viewing experience
Integrated Voice Communication During Shared Viewing	No integrated open communication line as part of synchronized playback	Integrated communication can accompany the synchronized viewing experience
Coast-to-Coast Shared Experience	No equivalent integrated Impala-style feature combining synchronized media control with an open communication line	Coast-to-Coast: synchronized viewing/control plus an open communication line between participants
Browser Experience	Plex Web is available, but the ecosystem is centered around Plex Media Server and Plex clients	Browser-first: open the link, sign in, and start using Impala
Client Applications	Extensive ecosystem of dedicated TV, mobile, desktop, streaming-device, and web clients	Browser-first approach reduces client installation requirements

COMPARISON	PLEX	IMPALA STREAMER
Remote Access Configuration	Home-server remote access may require networking configuration and troubleshooting	Hosted Impala access does not require the Family viewer to expose and maintain a home Plex server
Transcoding	Performed by the user's Plex server; hardware capability directly affects performance	Streaming/transcoding workload can be handled by Impala infrastructure rather than depending entirely on the Family user's PC
Scaling Cost	More users and higher-quality streams can require faster CPU/GPU, additional storage, better networking, and faster Internet upload	Scaling is handled at the Impala infrastructure level rather than requiring each Family user to upgrade a personal server
Hardware Failure	Owner is responsible for failed drives, server failures, backups, replacement hardware, and downtime	Family viewer is not responsible for maintaining dedicated streaming-server hardware
Power / Always-On Server	Personal server generally needs to remain powered and accessible for remote streaming	No dedicated always-on Family server required for hosted Impala content
Media Ecosystem	Major strength: mature platform, large user base, established metadata system, broad hardware/client support	Newer platform with a smaller ecosystem, focused on simplicity, sharing, synchronized experiences, and scalability
Customization / Control	Strong control over a personally operated media server	Owner-controlled Impala environment without requiring every viewer to operate infrastructure

COMPARISON	PLEX	IMPALA STREAMER
Subscription Model	Free functionality plus optional/paid Plex services and Plex Pass features	Family Impala currently offered free to encourage adoption and trial
Time to Try It	Someone without Plex infrastructure must acquire/configure hardware and build a Plex server; an existing Plex owner already has that infrastructure	Existing Plex/local-library owner is an ideal trial user: install Local Companion, connect the existing library, and try Impala without abandoning Plex
Migration Required to Try	N/A	No migration required — keep the existing media library and connect it through Local Companion
Existing Plex User	Existing investment remains tied to the Plex server environment	Can keep Plex exactly as it is while testing Impala against the same existing local media
External Sharing of Local Media	Plex can remotely share media hosted on the owner's Plex server	Planned Family capability: allow Local Companion media to be shared with authorized external Impala users
Barrier to Trial	Building Plex from scratch requires hardware, installation, configuration, storage, and ongoing administration	For someone who already owns a local media library: install Local Companion → connect media → sign in → try Impala

KEY BENEFITS

PLEX BENEFITS

Mature, established media platform

Large existing user community

Broad device/client support

IMPALA STREAMER BENEFITS

Extremely low barrier to trial

Family Impala is free to try

Browser-first access

PLEX BENEFITS

Mature metadata and library-management ecosystem

Strong personal-server management capabilities

Extensive support for personal media formats

Established TV/mobile/streaming-device applications

Owner maintains direct control of personal server hardware

Remote personal-library access

Large third-party knowledge/community base

Long-established product ecosystem

Familiar solution for experienced home-server users

IMPALA STREAMER BENEFITS

No dedicated Impala server purchase for Family users

No requirement to abandon an existing Plex installation

Existing local libraries connect through Local Companion

No media migration required to test Impala

Sync Play designed as a core feature

Integrated shared-viewing experience

Coast-to-Coast synchronized viewing and communication

Designed for significantly greater concurrency than a typical home media server

Infrastructure burden moves away from the Family viewer

CORE DIFFERENCE

PLEX: Build, configure, operate, maintain, upgrade, and troubleshoot your own media-server environment.

IMPALA STREAMER: Open Impala, connect your existing media, and stream — without requiring the Family user to build and operate another media server.

PERFECT IMPALA TRIAL SCENARIO

Already have Plex? Already have a local media library?

You already have everything you need.

1. Keep your Plex server.

2. Keep your existing media library exactly where it is.

3. Install Impala Local Companion.
4. Connect Local Companion to your existing media.
5. Open Impala Streamer.
6. Try it.

No migration. No replacement server. No commitment. No need to uninstall Plex.

IMPALA FAMILY — NEXT CAPABILITY

LOCAL MEDIA → EXTERNAL SHARING

Allow Family users to connect their existing local media through **Impala Local Companion** and securely share authorized media with external Impala users.

Your media. Your library. Impala connects the people.

